

ExpenseTrack

1. Executive Summary

ExpenseTrack is a simple web-based tool that helps individuals log daily expenses and view spending reports. It's designed for personal users, freelancers, and students who want better control over their finances. By making expense tracking fast and visual, it promotes healthier financial habits.

2. Problem Statement

- People struggle to remember or consistently log daily spending.
- Without visibility, users overspend in key categories like food or entertainment.
- Freelancers and students lack lightweight tools to track business or personal expenses.
- Manual tracking (spreadsheets, notes) is error-prone and time-consuming.

3. Goals & Success Metrics

Business Goals:

- Acquire 100,000 active users within 12 months.
- Enable fast, frictionless expense logging.
- Deliver actionable insights through simple reports.

Success Metrics:

- Weekly Active Users (WAU): 40,000 by end of Year 1
- Avg. expenses per user/week: ≥ 5
- Time to first expense entry: < 2 minutes post-signup

4. Target Users

Alex, the Freelancer

Works independently and needs to track client-related costs (transport, software, meals). Struggles with disorganized receipts and unclear tax deductions. Needs a simple way to log and review expenses monthly.

Sam, the Student

Lives on a fixed budget and wants to avoid overspending. Often forgets small daily purchases. Wants to see where money goes each week and stay within limits without complexity.

5. Scope

In Scope

- Secure user sign-up and login
- Add, view, edit, and delete expenses
- Predefined expense categories (Food, Transport, Utilities, Entertainment, Health)
- Monthly and category-based spending reports (charts + totals)
- Responsive web interface (desktop and mobile)

Out of Scope

- Bank account integration or automatic transaction import
- Shared expenses or multi-user accounts
- Mobile apps or offline mode
- Receipt scanning or file attachments
- Budgeting or forecasting features

6. Core Features (MVP)

User Authentication — Secure sign-up and login with session management.

Enables personalized access and protects user data. All features require login.

- User can register with email and password
- Passwords are hashed (bcrypt)
- Session persists until logout

Add Expense — Log a new expense with key details.

Makes it fast and intuitive to capture spending at the moment it happens.

- Form includes amount, category (dropdown), date (defaults to today), and notes
- Expense saved securely to database
- Only visible to the logged-in user

View Expense List — See all past expenses in a clean list.

Provides immediate feedback and visibility into spending history.

- List shows amount, category, date, and notes
- Sorted by date (newest first)
- Each item can be edited or deleted

Edit/Delete Expense — Correct mistakes or remove outdated entries.

Ensures data accuracy and user confidence in the log.

- Click “Edit” to update any field

- Delete with confirmation prompt
- Changes saved instantly to database

Expense Reports — Visual summary of spending by category and month.

Helps users understand patterns and make informed decisions.

- Bar/pie chart shows spending distribution by category
- User selects time range (e.g., current month)
- Total spending for period displayed clearly

Post-MVP Features

- Export reports to CSV
- Email summary reports
- Search and filter expenses
- Dark mode UI

7. Key User Flows

1. Sign Up & Log In

- Go to /login → Click “Sign Up” → Enter email & password → Confirm → Log in → Redirect to dashboard

2. Log a New Expense

- Click “Add Expense” → Fill amount, pick category, confirm date, add notes → Click “Save” → See updated list

3. View Expense List

- Go to /expenses → View list sorted by date → Scroll or tap to review entries

4. Edit an Expense

- On list, click “Edit” → Update any field → Click “Save” → View updated entry in list

5. View Monthly Report

- Go to /reports → Select “Monthly” → Pick month → View chart and total spending

8. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement	Target
Performance	API responds to 95% of requests quickly	p95 latency < 500ms

Security	User passwords must be securely hashed	bcrypt or stronger
Scalability	System supports growing user base reliably	100k DAU by Year 1

9. Open Questions & Risks

#	Question / Risk	Status	
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1	Should we allow custom expense categories?	Under review	
2	Risk: Users may abandon app if onboarding is slow	Mitigated by keeping UI simple and fast	
3	Should reports support export (CSV/PDF)?	Post-MVP	
4	Risk: Data loss if backend fails	Addressed via regular DB backups	
5	Can we ensure mobile touch usability?	Validated in design phase	